LESSON 5
INSTALLING AND CONFIGURING APPLICATIONS

UNDERSTANDING THE MICROSOFT STORE

PURPOSE OF THE MICROSOFT STORE



Centralized App Hub

The Microsoft Store acts as a centralized platform for downloading and installing diverse applications on Windows.

Verified and Secure Apps

Apps in the Store are verified to ensure security, minimizing risks of malware infections for users.

User-Friendly Features

Users can browse categories, read reviews, and manage app updates easily within the store's intuitive interface.

Seamless Windows Integration

The Microsoft Store integrates smoothly with Windows, simplifying app installation compared to traditional methods.

APP TYPES AND SECURITY

SANDBOXED APPS IN WINDOWS

Sandboxing for Security

Sandboxing isolates apps to restrict system and user data access, enhancing security in Windows environments.

UWP App Characteristics

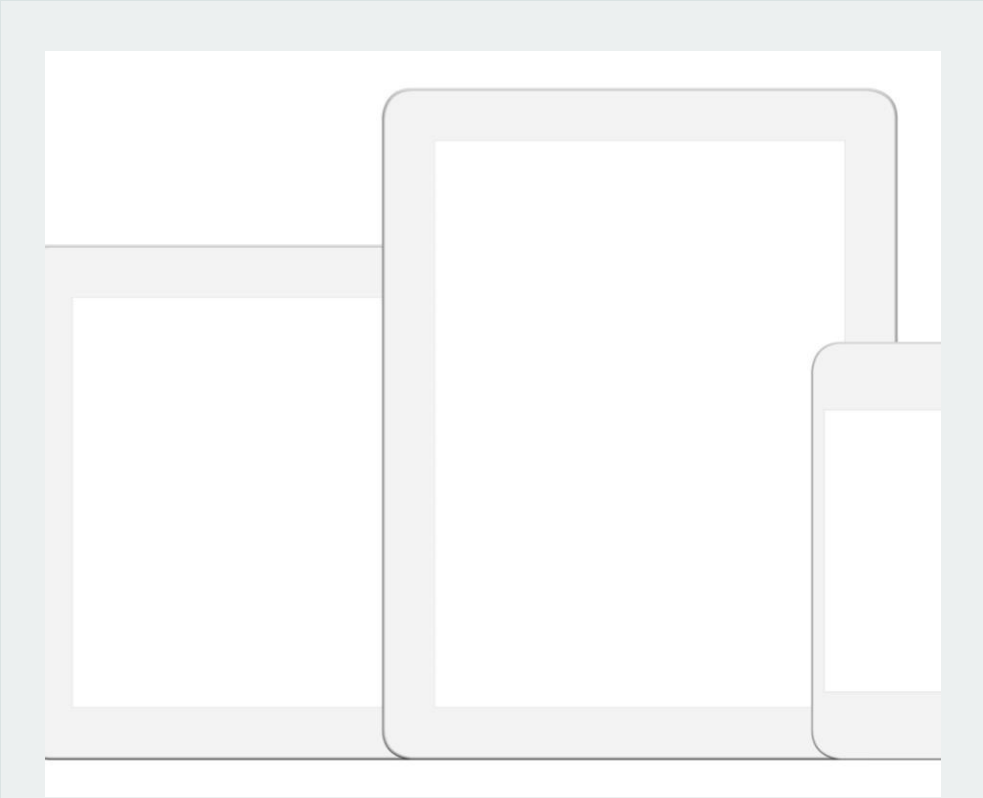
UWP apps are lightweight, secure, and compatible across multiple Windows devices, designed for controlled execution.

Legacy vs Modern Apps

Legacy desktop apps have broader system access, which can increase security risks compared to sandboxed UWP apps.



DIFFERENCES BETWEEN DESKTOP AND UWP APPS



Desktop Apps Overview

Desktop apps are traditional programs installed via executables with full system access and OS interaction.

UWP Apps Characteristics

UWP apps run in sandboxed environments, are store-based, and offer enhanced security and manageability.

Performance and Portability

UWP apps are optimized for performance and portability, suited for modern Windows interfaces.

Choosing the Right App Type

Understanding the differences helps users select apps tailored to their security and performance needs.

MANAGING INSTALLED APPLICATIONS

VIEWING AND UNINSTALLING APPS

Accessing Installed Apps

Navigate to Settings > Apps > Installed apps to view all desktop and UWP applications on the system.

Quick Uninstall Method

Right-click apps from the Start menu and select 'Uninstall' for a fast and user-friendly removal process.

Benefits of App Management

Effectively managing installed apps helps maintain system performance and keeps the computer organized.



INSTALLING APPS VIA COMMAND LINE

Winget Tool Overview

Winget is Windows Package Manager enabling app installation and management via command line on Windows 10 and 11.

Efficient Software Deployment

Winget allows IT professionals to automate software installation and upgrades through scripts, improving efficiency.

Enhanced Control and Flexibility

Using winget commands streamlines app installation and integrates with system management tools for better control.



APP MAINTENANCE AND PERFORMANCE

REPAIRING AND MONITORING APPS

App Repair Feature

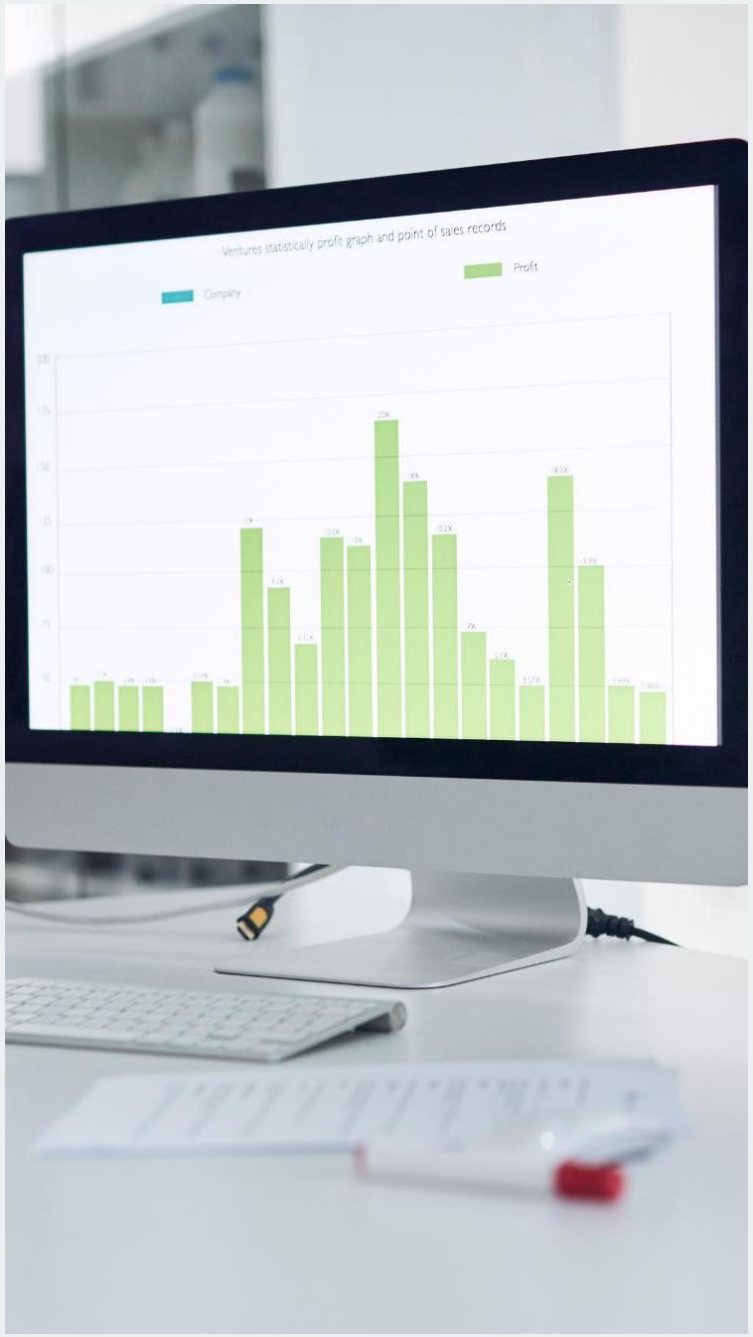
The repair option fixes application issues without uninstalling, preserving user data and settings.

Task Manager Monitoring

Task Manager shows running apps and background processes, enabling resource monitoring and troubleshooting.

Regular App Maintenance

Regular maintenance helps ensure applications run smoothly and efficiently without performance issues.



IMPACT OF STARTUP APPS

Startup App Impact

Too many startup apps slow system boot by consuming memory and CPU resources during launch.

Management via Task Manager

Users can enable or disable startup apps through Task Manager's Startup tab to control system load.

Performance Optimization

Reducing unnecessary startup apps enhances system performance and responsiveness effectively.



DEFAULT APPS AND FILE ASSOCIATIONS

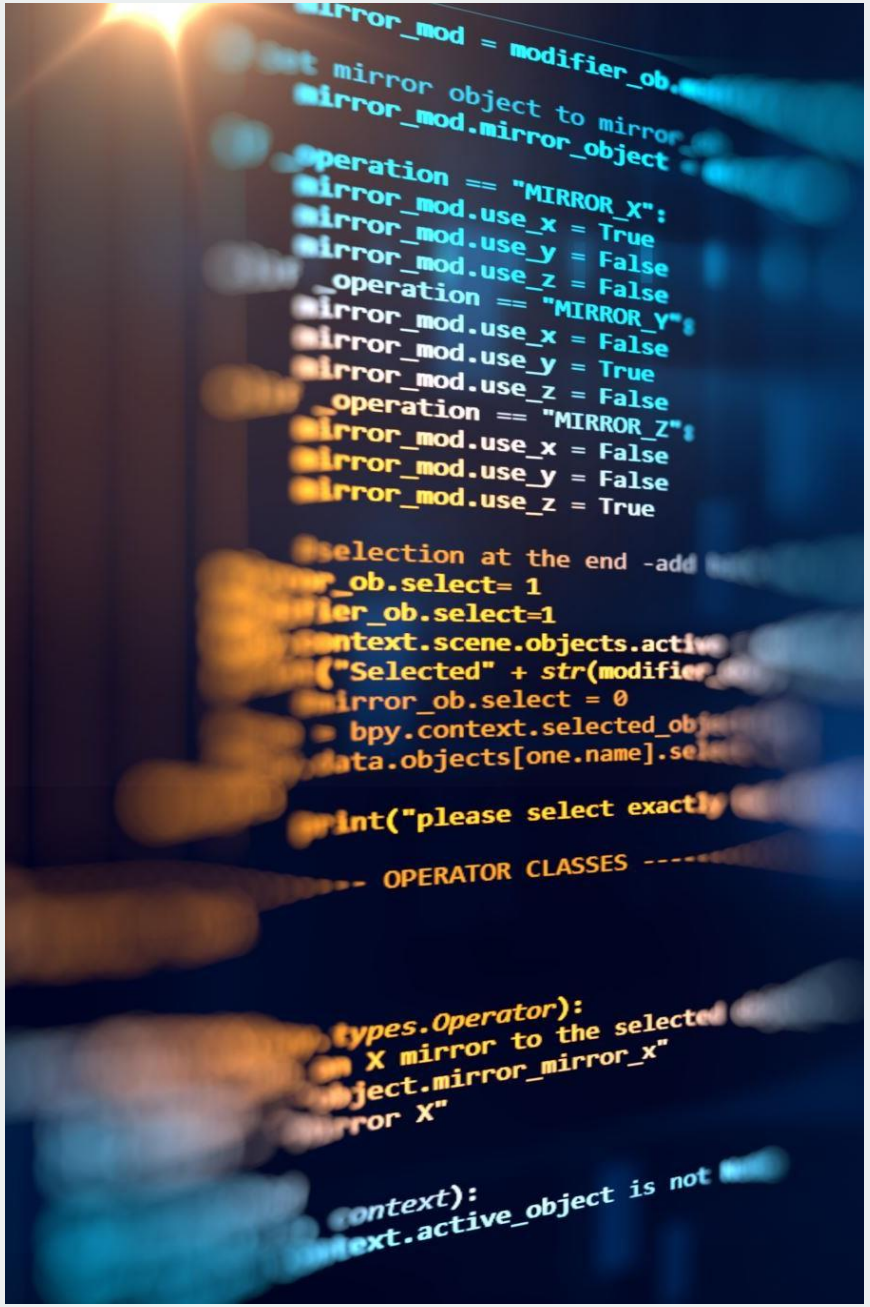
CHANGING AND RESETTING DEFAULT APPS

Changing Default Apps

Users can select preferred apps for file types and protocols via Settings > Apps > Default apps to personalize experience.

Resetting to Recommended Defaults

Users can reset all default apps to Microsoft recommended settings to restore compatibility and standard behavior.



WINDOWS FEATURES AND AUTOPLAY

MANAGING WINDOWS FEATURES

Accessing Features Dialog

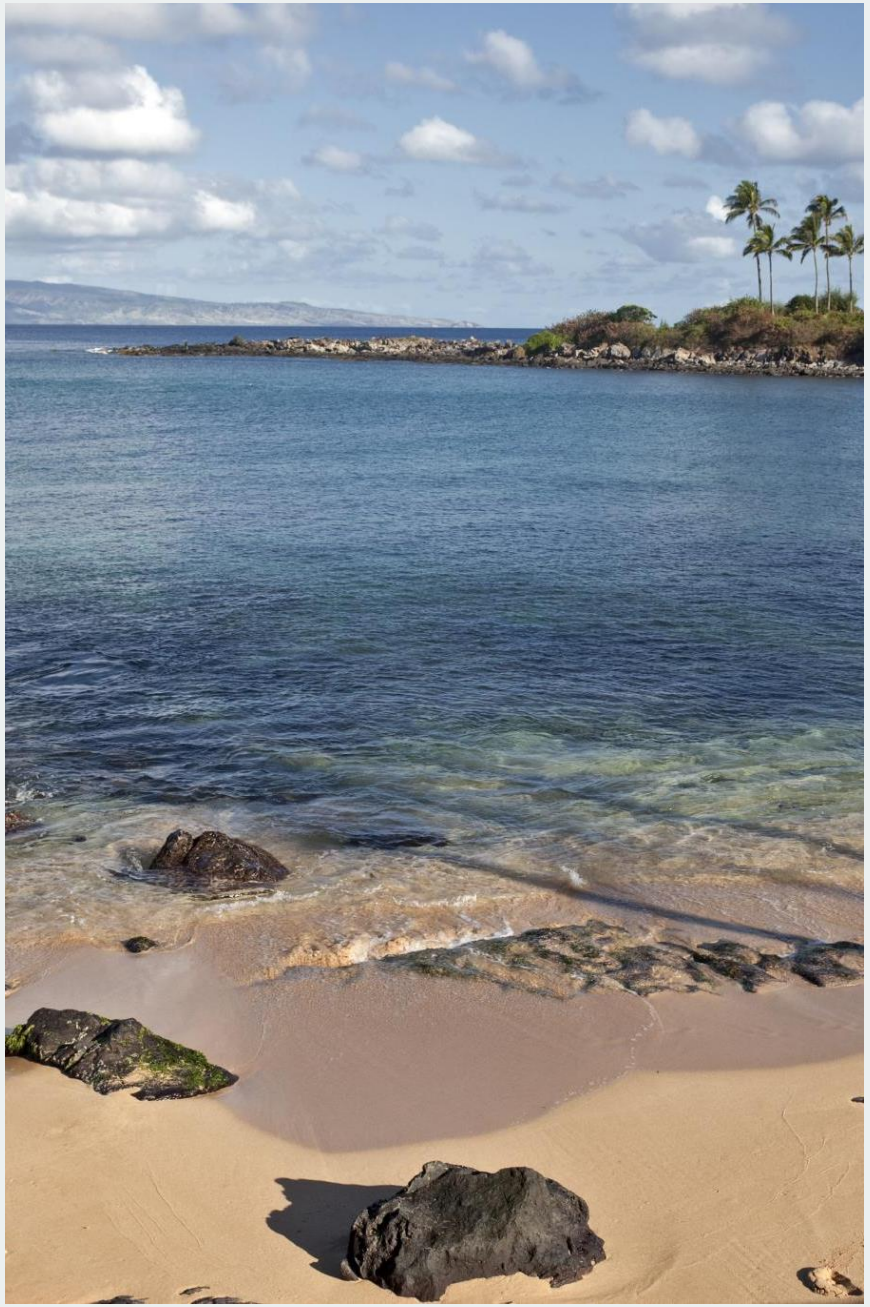
Users open 'Turn Windows features on or off' via Settings under Apps and Optional Features.

Applying Changes

System restart is often required after changing feature settings to apply updates.

Customization Benefits

Enabling or disabling features customizes system functionality and optimizes performance.



UNDERSTANDING AND DISABLING AUTOPLAY

AutoPlay Functionality

AutoPlay launches specific actions automatically when media devices like USB drives are inserted, offering convenience.

Security Risks of AutoPlay

AutoPlay can pose security risks by running unwanted or malicious apps without user consent.

Disabling AutoPlay

Users can disable AutoPlay for all devices via system settings to enhance security and control device behavior.



APP UPDATES AND HISTORY

IMPORTANCE OF KEEPING APPS UPDATED

Security Patches

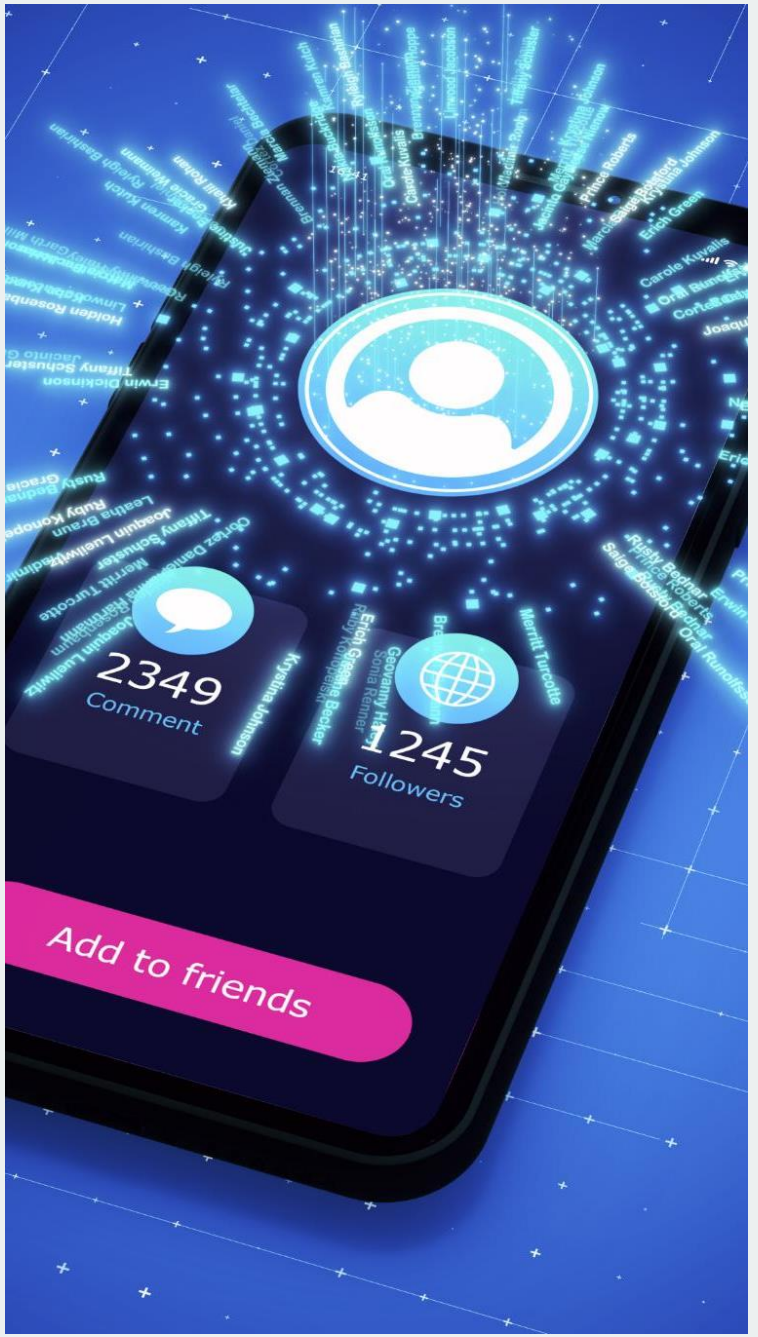
Regular updates apply security patches that protect apps from vulnerabilities and exploits.

Access to New Features

App updates provide users with new functionalities and improved performance.

Automatic Update Benefits

Enabling automatic updates ensures apps stay current, maintaining system integrity effortlessly.



USING TASK MANAGER'S APP HISTORY

Resource Usage Tracking

App History tab tracks CPU time, network usage, and other key resource metrics for each application over time.

Performance Management

Users can identify resource-heavy applications to better manage system performance and optimize usage.

Troubleshooting Aid

Monitoring app history helps troubleshoot issues by pinpointing apps causing high resource consumption.



SYSTEM STABILITY AND FEATURE MANAGEMENT

CONSEQUENCES OF UNINSTALLING WINDOWS FEATURES

Loss of Functionality

Removing Windows features may cause loss of critical system functions and user capabilities.

System Instability Risks

Disabling certain features can lead to system crashes or unpredictable behavior affecting stability.

Importance of Essential Components

Maintaining essential Windows components ensures smooth operation and wide software compatibility.

